

STAT 193

VUW / Te Herenga Waka

Using individualised datasets in written assignments and uploading individualised solutions;

Student AI use in assignments

1 July, 2026 – David Cox, Senior Lecturer (Teaching), School of Mathematics and Statistics

Assignment overview

- 3 written assignments (10% each)
 - due end of weeks 5, 9 and 12
 - AI use, tutor help and discussion with other students permitted
 - individually marked with feedback given
 - question(s) based on students' individualised data included in each
 - include all topics taught (previously linear regression was not covered in assignments as last topic taught in course)

Use of individual datasets

- Purpose: to encourage individual work on assignments
 - worthwhile, but not AI-resistant
- Students access their dataset via link in Canvas ('Nuku')
 - data consists of 200 rows from General Social Survey 2018-2021 SURF dataset
 - full dataset is 1,997 synthetic respondents
 - individual selection is based on username, year and trimester
 - same individual dataset for all 3 assignments
- Solutions generated in R
 - time-consuming initial setup needing very capable coder
 - markers provided with large pdf containing all (~500-600) individual solutions
 - in practice not too much extra work for markers
- Individual solutions then uploaded to Canvas (as well as generic solutions where individual data not used)

Example of dataset generated ($n = 200$)

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
1	Age	Gender	Ethnicity	Children	Health	Education	Hours	Income	Labour force status	Te reo ability	Home affordability	House cold
2	18	Female	European/Other	0	Excellent	Less than sec school	6	713.2027	Not in labour force	None or almost none	Affordable	Yes, often
3	27	Male	European/Other	2	Very Good	Post-sec school diploma	46	2375.814	Employed	None or almost none	Affordable	Yes, often
4	45	Male	European/Other	1	Excellent	Degree	18	2598.466	Employed	Conversational	Affordable	No
5	36	Male	European/Other	4	Excellent	Less than sec school	32	879.0452	Employed	Basic	Neither	No
6	18	Female	European/Other	0	Excellent	Less than sec school	56	601.3786	Employed	None or almost none	Affordable	Yes, often
7	51	Male	Māori	0	Very Good	Less than sec school	34	799.9112	Employed	Basic	Affordable	No
8	56	Male	European/Other	0	Excellent	Less than sec school	38	1067.213	Not in labour force	None or almost none	Affordable	No
9	30	Male	European/Other	4	Good	Degree	36	813.4657	Not in labour force	Basic	Affordable	Yes, often
10	26	Female	Māori	0	Excellent	Secondary school	17	666.5595	Employed	None or almost none	Unaffordable	No
11	25	Female	European/Other	0	Very Good	Secondary school	19	499.1223	Employed	Basic	Neither	No
12	43	Female	European/Other	1	Good	Post-sec school diploma	17	447.6951	Not in labour force	None or almost none	Affordable	No
13	53	Female	European/Other	3	Very Good	Secondary school	38	312.5494	Employed	None or almost none	Affordable	Yes, sometimes
14	51	Male	European/Other	0	Very Good	Less than sec school	67	1135.782	Not in labour force	None or almost none	Affordable	Yes, often
15	35	Female	Māori	2	Fair	Secondary school	32	1024.157	Unemployed	Basic	Affordable	No
16	34	Male	Asian	1	Very Good	Less than sec school	32	726.1591	Employed	None or almost none	Unaffordable	No
17	16	Female	European/Other	2	Good	Less than sec school	2	545.7655	Employed	None or almost none	Neither	No
18	46	Female	European/Other	4	Very Good	Less than sec school	61	1530.655	Not in labour force	None or almost none	Affordable	No
19	22	Male	European/Other	0	Good	Less than sec school	14	466.9208	Employed	None or almost none	Neither	Yes, sometimes

2018-2021 GSS Teaching SURF dataset

- The 2018-2021 General Social Survey (GSS) Teaching Synthetic Unit Record File (SURF) is a dataset consisting of 1,997 synthetic respondents that, when variables are aggregated, produce population-level estimates for people aged 15 years and older in New Zealand in 2018 and 2021 similar to what would be estimated if researchers were using the GSS microdata.
- The dataset request and coordination was led by Kate Prickett and Phillip Worthington at Victoria University of Wellington. Resourcing support for the 2018 data came from the libraries of Victoria University of Wellington, University of Auckland, Auckland University of Technology, University of Canterbury, and University of Otago. Resourcing support for the 2021 data was provided by the Victoria University of Wellington library.
- The dataset was developed by Statistics New Zealand (StatsNZ). The dataset consists of 1,997 unit records (997 in 2018, 1,000 in 2021) and 40 variables. Variables consist of a range of sociodemographic factors (e.g., age, sex, ethnicity, educational attainment, family structure, labour force status, household income, disability, home ownership, migrant status) and wellbeing indicators (e.g., life satisfaction, self-rated physical health, mental wellbeing, housing conditions, residential mobility, feelings of loneliness), as well as other behaviours and experiences (e.g., trust in government, voting behaviour, experience of discrimination, access to public transit and green space, being a victim of crime). A survey frequency weight is included.

Proposed AI guidance for assignments, 2026 Tri 2:

- These assignment questions are designed to help you learn the course content that you will be tested on in the final invigilated exam. To pass STAT 193, in the exam you must meet the mandatory course requirement of scoring at least 30% of the marks available, as well as achieving an overall course mark of at least 50%. It is therefore essential that you understand the questions asked in assignments, otherwise you may not be able to pass the course.
- You are allowed to discuss assignment questions with others to help you understand the concepts and you are also allowed to use AI tools such as ChatGPT. If you choose to use AI, make sure you do so to **assist** your learning, as opposed to replacing your learning. For example, by carefully reading and editing the AI output so that you understand it, and so that you answer the questions asked. Otherwise you may find that you are unable to correctly answer many of the questions in the final exam and you fall below the threshold required to pass the course. In our experience, students who work through the assignment questions themselves will generally be successful in the course.
- Note also that you will not have access to any electronic device except a calculator in the final exam